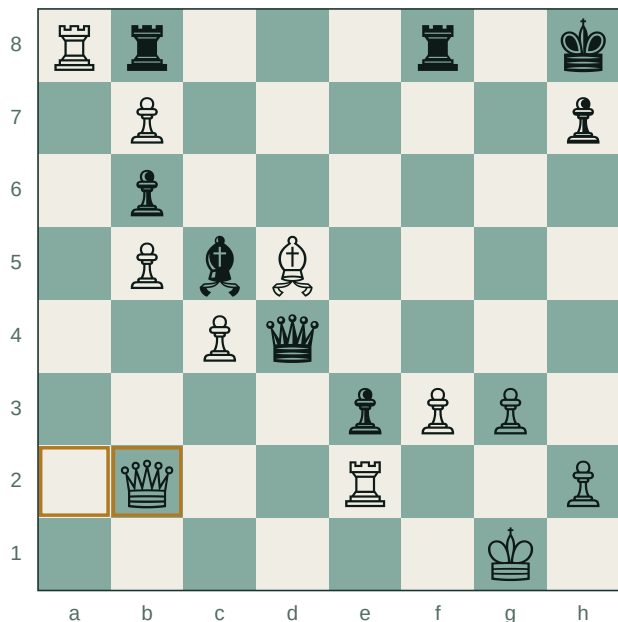


Promotion combinations: Black, move 31

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Qb2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Qxb2 32. Rxb2 e2+ 33. Kg2 e1=Q

31...Qxb2 The queen captures the queen on b2. Recorded reply: **32.Rxb2**.

32...e2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on c5 attacks the king on g1. Recorded reply: **33.Kg2**.

33...e1=Q The pawn moves from e2 to e1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.